

Unit-I

Physical fitness

Introduction

Physical fitness is one of the core preconditions of health. We cannot imagine a person being healthy without being physically fit. Physical fitness, therefore, needs to be appreciated in full measure. The common perception of physical fitness is the absence of ailment. If an individual is not suffering from any perceptible disease, he is considered physically fit. Is it true? Another significant issue is whether a universal condition of physical fitness is uniformly applicable to all. It is not so. The physical fitness of young people is different from that of the aged. The physical fitness of a sports person is different from that of those working in army factories or laymen. Physical fitness means other things to different people. In this lesson, let us discuss various aspects of physical fitness.

Physical Fitness and its Importance

In earlier classes, physical fitness has been defined as the capacity of a person to carry out the daily activities without undue fatigue. Physical fitness is considered as a measure of the body's ability to function efficiently and effectively during work and leisure activities. In order to remain physically fit and healthy, we need to engage ourselves in physical activities and take measures for physically fit. Physical fitness is an important area of discussion as the number of childrens becoming obese. The normal physical activities, which were done in earlier times both at home and outside as part of day-to-day routine have reduced due to development of science and technology. The work that was done manually is now being carried out by machines. The use of automated equipment such as automatic machines, remotes, mobiles and changes in lifestyles affect health and physical fitness. It has become a matter of deep thinking for all of us. Now a days we find increased marketing of packaged food and diet for physical fitness. Many such health products now are advertised on TV and radio, and in newspapers, booklets and magazine. It is important for all of us to understand that physical fitness cannot be achieved without doing physical exercise regularly. We should not resort to any shortcut that is frequently advertised in the media these days to achieve fitness or maintain balance in life style. Moreover, these products may have side effects in our daily life.

Need of Physical Fitness and Well-being

As discussed in the first chapter on Health and Diseases, the benefits of being physically fit for the individual are manifold. The quality of life of an individual improves when he/she consciously adopts healthy lifestyle which promotes physical fitness as follows:

Physical fitness

- improves the functioning of heart and lungs by increasing the availability of oxygen to all tissues and organs in the body system;
- improves muscle tone;
- promotes the development of good posture, proportionate figure, and thereby positive body image and physical appearance;
- ensures quick recovery after injury and illness;
- decreases the risk of cardio-vascular disease; (like Heart attack, Asthma etc.)
- reduces and controls undesirable body fat. When the individual does exercise, takes proper diet that also fulfils nutritional requirement, it helps maintain ideal body weight;
- increases energy level of a person;
- improves the mood by reducing depression and anxiety;
- postpones fatigue and reduces recovery time after vigorous activity; and
- helps people to meet challenges of life, makes them selfconfident and delays the ageing process. Being physically fit is important for all the age groups. To live better life to the fullest and enjoy all the opportunities, one try to be physically fit. Physical fitness is essential for each and every individual at all stages of life. To achieve fitness, various modes and methods are available. Before adopting such methods, warming up before activities and cooling down after activities are essential to minimise any risk of injuries of an every individual.

Components of Physical Fitness

Physical fitness can be classified into health related fitness and skill-related fitness.

The health-related components are:

i) Cardiovascular Fitness, (ii) Muscular Strength, (iii) Muscular Endurance, (iv) Body Composition and (v) Flexibility.

The skill- Related Fitness Components are:

- (i) Agility, (ii) Balance, (iii) Neuro Muscular Adaptations and Coordinative abilities, (iv) Speed, (v) Strength, and (vi) Reaction Time.

Components of Health Related Fitness

Cardio-respiratory Endurance: cardio-respiratory endurance reflects the ability of the body's circulatory and respiratory systems to supply fuel during sustained physical activity. To improve your cardio-respiratory endurance, try activities that keep your heart rate elevated at a safe level for a sustained length of time such as walking, running, jogging, swimming, bicycling etc. The activity you choose need not be strenuous enough to improve your cardio-respiratory endurance. Start slowly with an activity you enjoy, and gradually work up increase to a more intense pace.

Muscular Strength is the amount of force applied on muscle or muscle groups, is able to exert for one maximal effort (contraction). The key to making your muscles stronger is working them against resistance, whether that be from weights or gravity. If you want to gain muscle strength, try exercises such as lifting weights (under proper supervision).

Muscular Endurance is the ability of a muscle or muscle group to exert force against a submaximal load for a given length of time (or number of repetition) before fatiguing to the point of failure.

Body Composition refers to the proportion of lean body mass to body fat, it includes amount of muscle, fat, bone, and other vital parts of the body. Body composition is important to be considered for health and managing the body fat.

Flexibility is the range of motion around a joint. Good flexibility in the joints can help prevent injuries through all stages of life. If you want to improve your flexibility, try yoga, gymnastics and basic stretching exercise programme.

Components of Skill-related Fitness

Agility is the ability to change and control the direction and position of the body while maintaining a constant, rapid motion. For example changing directions to hit a tennis ball.

Balance is the ability to control or stabilise the body when a person is standing still or moving. For example, handstand in gymnastics.

Coordination is the ability to use the senses together with body parts during movement. For example, dribbling a basketball. Using hands and eyes together is called hand-eye coordination.

Speed is the ability to move your body or parts of your body swiftly. Many sports rely on speed to gain advantage over opponents. For example, a Basketball player making a fast break to perform a lay-up, a tennis player moving forward to get to a drop shot, a football player running the defense to receive a pass.

Power is the ability to move the body parts swiftly while applying the maximum force of the muscles. Power is a combination of both speed and muscular strength. For example, volleyball players lifting up to the net and lifting their bodies high into the air.

Reaction Time is the ability to reach or respond quickly to what you hear, see or feel. For example, an athlete quickly coming off the blocks early in a swimming or track event, or stealing a base in baseball.

Wellness

The state of being healthy and free from disease.

CONCEPT OF WELLNESS

The WHO defines health as "a state of physical, mental, and social well-being, not merely the absence of disease." While the term Health focuses on an individual's illness status and her/his relationship to that status, wellness transcends the absence of disease. It is much more than merely physical health, exercise or nutrition. In fact, wellness is the full integration of states of physical, mental, and spiritual well-being. Wellness is about living a life full of personal responsibility and, therefore, taking proactive steps for one's entire well-being. This means that a person living a life of wellness controls risk factors that can harm her/him. Risk factors are different types of actions or conditions that increase a person's chances for illness or injury. e.g., smoking is a risk factor as there is a risk for developing lung cancer. Alcohol is a risk factor as there is a risk for developing liver damage. So, an individual takes pro-active steps to remove such health risks from her/his life.

Maintaining an optimal level of wellness is absolutely crucial to living a higher quality

life. Wellness matters because everything we do, and every emotion we feel, relates to our well-being. In turn, our well-being directly affects our actions and emotions. It's an on going circle. Therefore, it is important for everyone to achieve optimal wellness in order to reduce stress and the risk of illness and to ensure positive interactions. Thus, wellness may be defined as "the optimal state of health of individuals and groups. There are two focal concerns: the realization of the fullest potential of an individual physically, psychologically, socially, spiritually, and economically, and the fulfilment of one's role expectations in the family, community, place of worship, workplace, and other settings." – WHO Health Promotion Glossary Update 2006.

The integration of many different components (physical, emotional/mental, intellectual, social, and spiritual) that expand one's potential to live (quality of life) and work effectively and to make a significant contribution to society. Wellness reflects how one feels (a sense of well-being) about life, as well as one's ability to function effectively. Wellness, as opposed to illness (a negative), is sometimes described as the positive component of good health.

Training Principles

Participating in regular physical activity and exercise throughout every week may positively impact an individual's overall health, and improve various components of physical fitness. However, an individual's specific physical fitness goals may not be achieved if their physical activity program is not designed with respect to major exercise training principles. Adherence to specific principles of exercise training may aid in the development of an intentional and successful physical activity regimen. The core training principles which will be subsequently discussed include:

Specificity

Overload

Progression

Reversibility

FITT

Individual Differences

Specificity Principle:

Only the body parts, muscles, or systems involved in a workout will be experiencing training (American College of Sports Medicine, 2013). For example, upper body weight training will only facilitate improvements to muscles groups which were engaged (i.e. shoulders, arms, back muscles). Therefore, an individual must evaluate the specific type of workout that will provide the greatest likelihood of physical activity and fitness goal achievement.

Overload Principle:

Overload (i.e., "greater than normal workload or exertion") is required to improve components of health-related fitness: cardiorespiratory (aerobic) endurance, muscular strength, muscular endurance and flexibility. According to the principle of overload, an individual must work ("load") the body using a step-by-step increase in physical activity duration, time, and/or intensity in order to facilitate optimal fitness improvements (American College of Sports Medicine, 2013). This step-by-step increase is often known as **progression**.

Reversibility Principle:

Individuals may lose the beneficial effects of training when participation in an exercise program is terminated (i.e., fitness gains are reversed; colloquially known as "use it or lose it"). Conversely, as an individual's fitness level improves, s/he will be required to adjust the exercise program in order to procure further improvements (i.e., the previous work exerted to reach overload may no longer be sufficient) (American College of Sports Medicine, 2013a).

FITT Principle:

The exercise training principle which outlines how an individual may design and monitor their individualized exercise program (American College of Sports Medicine, 2013).

1. **Frequency:** How often the individual performs the targeted exercise or physical activity.
2. **Intensity:** How much work or effort is exerted during a physical activity period (may be measured in a variety of ways such as heart rate, RPE, MET value, etc.).
3. **Time:** Duration of physical activity or exercise bout.
4. **Type:** Specific physical activity mode or exercise which an individual chooses to engage in (i.e. aerobic exercise, resistance training, sports-specific activity, etc.).

Individual Differences Principle:

All individuals are unique in their exercise programming needs. Personal, environmental, and behavioral factors should be considered and assessed when planning to engage in a physical fitness training regimen (American College of Sports Medicine, 2013).

Current or Latest Latest Fitness Trends

1 - An Increase In Home Gyms

Although popular pre-pandemic, lockdown accelerated the popularity of home workouts and led to some of the biggest fitness equipment trends, and particularly with people building home gyms.

This is still one of the biggest current fitness trends, as people are continuing to make the most of the equipment they've invested in.

Consequently, the demand for at-home gym equipment remains high, and continues to be one of the trends in health and fitness for 2022.

Smart fitness equipment is another one of the biggest fitness technology trends, with devices that connect via Wi-Fi or Bluetooth to stream virtual classes and interact with other users.

For instance, brands such as Peloton, who sell stationary bikes that allow you to train with a virtual coach, remain one of the latest fitness trends that will stick around in 2022.

This is because, for a lot of people, smart home equipment is often more cost effective over time if they usually stick to one piece of equipment or one style of class.

You don't have to invest in several expensive cardio machines to capitalise on this trend; you could go much more minimal and invest in some free weights or a yoga mat instead.

2 - Gyms Starting Hybrid Memberships

Another one of the latest fitness trends is a combination of people heading back to the gym whilst still embracing the home workouts established during lockdown.

Some people have embraced the best of both worlds heading to the gym a few days a week, whilst still capitalising on the fitness technology trends and working out at home when it's more convenient.

As a result, many gyms have chosen to adapt to health and fitness industry trends such as this one, and boost their gym revenue with hybrid memberships.

This allows members to use all of the equipment on the gym floor, and join in-person classes, combined with virtual workouts that they can perform in the comfort of their own homes.

3 - Increased Concern About Gym Hygiene

In a world forced to be more aware of contamination during Covid, one of the latest fitness trends to emerge is a heightened awareness of hygiene in sports centres and gyms.

Most gyms have therefore introduced new hygiene and safety measures in order to reduce transmission. Some of these include:

- Compulsory sanitisation of equipment after use
- A reduction in class sizes
- A limit on the number of members in gyms at any one time.

Consequently, many brands have capitalised on these health and fitness trends, and have chosen to introduce or push products that allow users to prioritise their gym hygiene levels and wellbeing.

4 - More Frequent Outdoor Exercise

With 90% of our time being spent indoors during lockdown, it's no surprise that the next on our list of physical fitness trends is an increase in people choosing to exercise outdoors.

Although many people chose to begin working out from the comfort of their own homes when gyms closed, others chose to benefit from the great outdoors instead when restrictions first started to be reduced.

Outdoor exercise continues to be one of the biggest global fitness trends as it's ideal for those who remain hesitant about returning to the gym or other fitness facilities.

Not only does it offer an alternative form of exercise for the clinically vulnerable, but outdoor training and forms of exercise such as:

- Bike rides
- Organised hikes
- Group walks
- Running meets

One of the most interesting future fitness trends in this vein is the increasing popularity of stroller fitness.

Stroller fitness is one of the latest fitness trends that offers parents the benefits of exercising outdoors whilst bonding with their babies.

It may sound like a fitness fad, but don't underestimate the power of walking with a stroller! The intensity of this exercise can easily be increased and made to incorporate some of the following:

- Calf stretches
- Lunges and lunge walks
- Upper chest exercises, such as chest presses or pulls

5 - Increased Demand For Shorter Workouts

As more people return to work and our lives become busier again, one of the latest health and fitness trends is making workouts as quick and effective as possible.

Known as the 'micro workout,' this is one of the latest fitness trends to incorporate a holistic workout that embraces:

- Strength training
- Flexibility training
- Mobility exercises
- Cardio and aerobics

6 - Increased Popularity in HIIT Workouts

HIIT workouts, standing for high-intensity interval training, consist of short bursts of activity, with short rest periods in between.

As an intense form of exercise that can be performed in a relatively short period of time, HIIT is therefore one of the most efficient ways of working out!

As well as being time efficient, another one of the benefits of HIIT training is that it's great for losing weight.

HIIT also continues to be one of the most popular global fitness trends, because of its suitability for a range of abilities, as well as its accessibility.

For instance, HIIT can be performed using machines such as stationary bikes or ellipticals, but you can also perform it simply using intervals of bodyweight exercises, or running uphill in spurts.

This remains one of the biggest fitness technology trends too, with HIIT apps being some of the home workout favourites during lockdown.

Fitness influencers such as Joe Wicks have contributed to HIIT being one of the biggest trends in the fitness industry too, by releasing free workouts on YouTube and Instagram.

7- Lower-Impact Exercise to Protect Joints

This means that people are looking to work on daily functional movements, in order to improve:

- Strength
- Flexibility
- Mobility

Low impact workouts are highly beneficial for these elements of physical health, and performing them can help reduce the risk of injury in more intense workouts.

Some of the low impact exercises that remain some of the biggest trends in the fitness industry are:

- Walking
- Rowing
- Yoga & Pilates

- Swimming
- Barre

8 - Overall Wellness as a Fitness Goal

For instance, scientific studies have shown that gentle yoga styles can help to boost the immune system.

The physical stretches that yoga practice involves, plus the added benefits of meditation, help to promote mental as well as physical wellbeing.

This shows how attitudes towards fitness today are beginning to shift, and are going beyond achieving the perfect bikini body.

That's why we're beginning to see the latest fitness trends embrace overall wellness and use exercise as part of a regime including:

- Getting a good night's sleep
- Consuming a healthy and balanced diet
- Taking supplements
- Prioritising recovery, including stretching, foam rolling, and sports massage
- Incorporating meditation into your daily routine

9 - Treating Exercise as Treatment or Medicine

Exercise is Medicine (EIM) is a global health initiative that has been designed to promote these ideas.

Provided by Anytime Fitness and Technogym, EIM aims to make physical activity assessment a standard in clinical care for people of all abilities.

They aim to connect health care with evidence-based physical activity resources, to promote exercise's role in medical care

Another new initiative which promotes exercise as a form of treatment is CrossFit's 'Precision Care' health programme.

Originally founded with the aim of pushing people towards fitness and preventing illness, CrossFit-trained health professionals provide personal healthcare through the programme, based on:

- Your unique genes
- Your biomarkers
- Any specific goals and needs you may have

Some of these ideas and use the following to focus on exercise as a preventative treatment:

- Blood tests
- Genetic analysis
- Doctor consultations

EIM and ‘Precision Care’ are just two examples of recent initiatives which promote exercise as medicine, which continues to grow as one of the biggest trends in the fitness industry

10 - Incorporating Mind-Body Practices into Fitness Regimes

A mind-body practice is considered to be a type of complementary and alternative medicine, which utilises a mixture of the following, to relax both and mind:

- Movements of the body
- Mental focus
- Controlled breathing

Some common examples of this type of practice include:

- Yoga
- Tai Chi
- Meditation

These latest fitness trends grew hugely in popularity during lockdown. As a result, many of these can be found as part of class timetables in gyms and health clubs, right alongside more traditional gym classes!

Even national gym chains, like Virgin Active, have started to incorporate more alternative exercises into their timetable:

11 - Increased Use of Wearable Wellness Trackers

Following some of the holistic wellbeing trends in the fitness industry, many people are looking to brands to provide new ways for them to feel their best, and build healthy lifestyles. This is where wellness trackers come in. Advances in wearable fitness trackers, smart watches, and heart rate monitors have made it easier for the health conscious to collect new metrics such as:

- Blood pressure
- Oxygen saturation
- Respiratory rate

Some trackers even offer an electrocardiogram option, to help you keep on top of your heart health!

Human performance company WHOOP has released a new version of their fitness and recovery tracker with new features and capabilities including a skin temperature sensor and a sleep coach

12 - Increased Demand for Wellness Coaches

Wellness coaches have become one of the biggest health and fitness industry trends for this year, as they help to establish long term habits and achieve the aforementioned '360 wellness'.

Rather than focusing purely on fitness, health and wellness coaches use theories of behaviour science to create their training programmes.

Wellness coaches are also trained in implementing strategies to cultivate positive mindsets, as well as those that will help to increase their client's confidence and sense of motivation. This means that clients will not only be able to reach their goals in the gym, but also in everyday life too

13 - Centering Music and Collaborations with Musicians

Exercising to music is far from a new trend in the fitness industry with plenty of people centering classes around particular styles of music, or aiming to create the definitive workout playlist.

The reason it's one of the newest fitness trends to surge in popularity is that more brands and companies are beginning to capitalise on the use of music as a tool for improving performance and engagement with their clients.

For instance, the stationary cycling brand Peloton has collaborated with artists such as Beyonce and Billie Eilish to launch live workout classes which harness the power of music, and get consumers excited to exercise at home

14 - Pushing For Inclusivity in Fitness

One of the most significant differences with these trends in the fitness industry is the challenging of old ideals to create a more diverse and inclusive fitness industry.

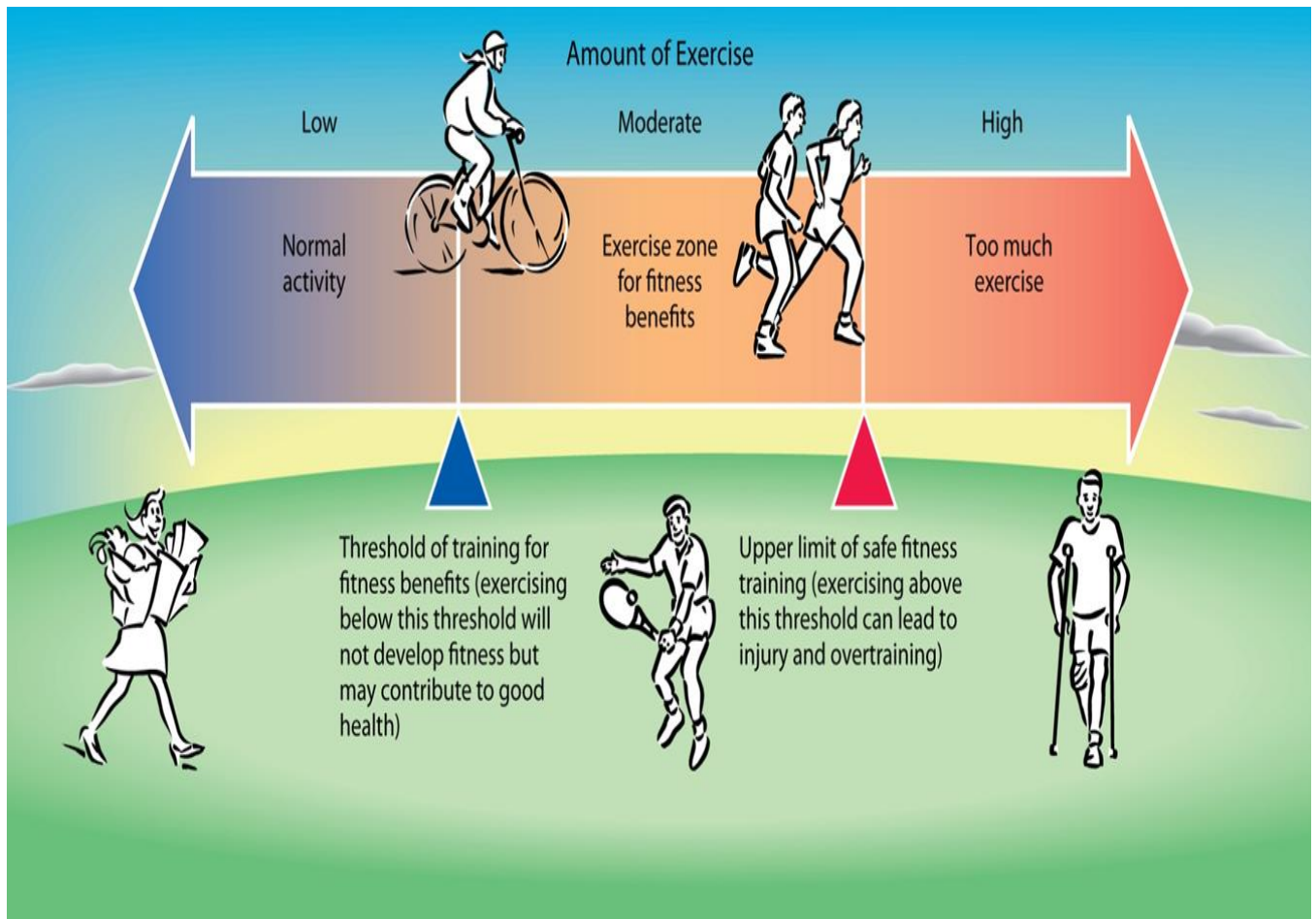
For instance, fitness streaming app Kakana offers classes which are tailored specifically to people with limited mobility with many of the instructors themselves leading classes from their wheelchairs.

Similarly, Jabbie is another inclusive and body positive app which goes above and beyond current health and fitness industry trends.

The free fitness app also offers a range of classes including:

- Dance
- HIIT
- Yoga
- Stretching

Amount of Exercise for Fitness Benefits



THE SEVEN COMPONENTS OF WELLNESS

Most people think that physical fitness alone is sufficient to lower the risk of healthrelated diseases but it is not true. e.g., consider an individual who regularly does vigorous physical trainingin which she/he does aerobic exercises thrice a week, does weight training, and stretching and maintains a good ratio of fat percentage of the body, but at the same time she/he eats junk food regularly, smokes and drinks alcohol. By doing so, she/he is increasing her/his chances of suffering from cardiovascular disease and other health related issues. Wellness includes factors like spirituality, healthy diet, regular physical activity, personal safety, avoiding drug abuse, preserving environment, prevention of disease, stress management etc. In fact, there are seven components of wellness namely physical, emotional, mental, social, environmental, occupational, and spiritual which are interlinked with each other.

Components of Wellness

Physical Wellness –

Physical wellness is an individual's ability to meet the demands of day to day work and being able to take care of her/his health. Overall physical wellness encourages the balance of physical activity, nutrition and mental well-being to keep the body in top condition. Obtaining an optimal level of physical wellness allows the individual to nurture personal responsibility for her/his own health. As the individual becomes conscious of her/his physical health, she/he is able to identify elements she/he is successful in, as well as elements she/he would like to improve. Physical Wellness includes regular vigorous activities, balanced diet, proper rest, avoiding intake of tobacco or alcohol, living in a healthy environment, following safety precautions etc. A physically fit individual must have optimum muscular endurance, muscular strength, cardio vascular endurance, flexibility and a fit body composition.

Emotional Wellness –

Emotional wellness inspires self-care, relaxation, stress reduction and the development of inner strength. It is an individual's ability to understand and balance her/his emotions, accept her/his own weaknesses, and respect another's strength. It is important to be attentive to one's positive and negative feelings and be able to understand how to handle these emotions. It allows the individual to accept her/his feelings. Once the individual accepts her/his feelings, she/he begins to understand why she/he is feeling that way, and can decide how she/he would like to act in response to those feelings. Emotional wellness also includes the ability to learn and grow from experiences. It is important in today's life that an individual should be able to cope with stress, adjust to one's environment, enjoy her/his life. Trust, self-esteem, self-confidence, optimism are key words for emotional wellbeing.

Mental Wellness –

Mental wellness, also known as intellectual wellness, is an individual's ability to learn, evaluate, accept new ideas, develop creative thinking, have a good sense of humour, and promote a lifelong learning process. Intellectual wellness encourages the individual to engage in creative and mentally-stimulating activities that expand her/his knowledge and skills while allowing her/him to share them with others. Intellectual wellness can be developed through academics, cultural involvement, community involvement and personal hobbies. Intellectual

wellness encourages learning and enables the individual to explore new ideas and understandings. It also stimulates curiosity, thereby developing a desire to try new things. An individual with intellectual wellbeing is open-minded and clear, enthusiastic to gather knowledge, accepting of ideas put forth by others.

Social Wellness –

It is an individual's ability to positively interact with the people of different cultures, ages, gender, religion etc. without building stereotypes. Social wellness refers to the relationships an individual may have and how she/he interacts with others. Her/His relationships can offer support during difficult times. Social wellness involves building healthy, nurturing and supportive relationships. Conscious actions are important in learning how to balance one's social life with one's academic and professional lives. Surrounding oneself with a positive social network increases one's self-esteem. Social wellness enables an individual to establish communication and trust and to manage conflict. Having good social wellness is critical to building emotional resilience.

Environmental Wellness –

Environmental wellness refers to respecting the environment and natural resources. Environmental wellness inspires the individual to live a lifestyle that is respectful of one's surroundings and leading the individual to take action to protect it. It promotes respect for all nature and all species living in it. It encourages the individual to adopt habits that promote a healthy environment resulting in a more balanced lifestyle. It helps develop habits like producing and eating organic food, minimising the use of petroleum products, and reducing air, water, noise and land pollution or food contamination. We are answerable to future generations in regard to natural resources. We should recycle the products which we use and reduce waste and pollution.

Occupational Wellness –

Occupational Wellness is the ability to achieve a balance between work and leisure time, addressing workplace stress and building relationships with co-workers. It focuses on the individual's search for a calling and involves exploring various career options and finding where one fits. Occupational wellness deals with satisfaction from job and career of an individual. It is not about holding a big post in a company or drawing a high salary etc. e.g., Individual 'A' may have a good salary in a reputed company, but she/he may not be able to

execute the plans or policies of the company effectively. Thus she/he may be stressed. Whereas Individual 'B', drawing a lesser salary and occupying a lower post than A may be satisfied with her/his life. An individual picking up a job should consider internal and external rewards.

Spiritual Wellness –

Generally, people think that spiritual wellness is linked with religion, but the core of spiritual wellness is to find the meaning and direction of life. Spiritual wellness allows an individual to be in tune with her/his spiritual self and to appreciate her/his life experiences for what they are. It lets one find meaning in life events and define one's individual purpose. By finding meaning in her/his life experiences, the individual will be able to develop a harmony between her/his inner self and the outside world. A spiritually well individual should have beliefs, principles and values which guide and strengthen her/his life. By following the path of spirituality an individual gets faith, love, peace, joy, closeness with others, altruism, compassion and forgiveness.

Thus, we can see that all the components of wellness are linked with each other. Wellness is holistic, because rather than focusing on symptoms, it is important to integrate body, mind, and spirit as one whole person. Wellness also considers the self as the only true healer as one's wellness is one's own responsibility. Health professionals can only help facilitate the healing process. It is the individual's body, mind, and spirit that do all the healing. Therefore, it is important to think positive thoughts as negative thinking strips one of power and control. Wellness is outcome-oriented. As soon as one is able to identify a problem, one's energy must be put into the solutions.

IMPORTANCE OF WELLNESS

Wellness requires continuous and thoughtful efforts to remain healthy and to reach the highest level of wellbeing. Overall physical wellness is achieved through the balance of physical activity, nutrition and mental well-being to keep your body in top condition. Health related lifestyle habits lead to longevity, improve quality of life and help achieve total wellbeing. After reading seven dimensions of wellness an individual can understand the importance of wellness:

- Wellness Programme should be developed with an aim to providing health-related lifestyle education with required support and resources to achieve wellness.

- Wellness makes the individual responsible for taking good decisions and adopting good practices and preventative measures for achieving optimum level of physical, emotional and social functioning.
- Wellness Programmes enable an individual to understand health issues like chronic diseases, cancer, cardiovascular disease, STDs, obesity, nutrition, diabetes, injuries, and other lifestyle related diseases and enhances longevity and the quality of healthy life.
- It promotes the behaviours which help maintain good health like quitting smoking, giving up alcohol abuse etc. and reducing social evils like violence, abuse, child labour, gender inequality, caste system etc. and adoption of positive values that result in an individual becoming a good citizen of the country.
- It also enables an individual to maintain balance between work, personal life and health that results in efficient and consistent output and improves general health, and fitness through adopting regular physical activities.
- It also helps to develop healthy social environment where people share and solve personal and social problems, thus making the individual socially accessible and culturally sensitive.
- Wellness components like physical, emotional, mental, social, environmental, occupational, and spiritual are highly interconnected and can help to make the environment disease and pollution free.